First Read

China Medtech

Surprisingly favourable IVD test pricing from Anhui's draft for comment solicitation

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China

Medical Products

Jun Deng
Analyst
jun.deng@ubs.com
+852-3712 2103

Emma Ma, CFA
Analyst
S1460526080001
emma-mc.ma@ubs.com
+86-21-3866 8981

Chen Chen, PhD
Analyst
S1460520100001
chen-zb.chen@ubs.com
+86-10-5832 8201

Doug Schenkel
Analyst
doug.schenkel@ubs.com
+1-617-235 1361

Tomoko Yoshihara
Analyst
tomoko.yoshihara@ubs.com
+81-3-5208 6212

Kavya Deshpande
Analyst
kavya.deshpande@ubs.com
+44-20-7567 8515

Matthew Weston, PhD
Analyst
matthew.weston@ubs.com
+44-20-7567 4055

Patrick Wood
Analyst
patrick.wood@ubs.com
+1-212-713 3018

Graham Doyle
Analyst
graham.doyle@ubs.com
+44-20-7568 2587

New test prices came in meaningfully better than market expectations

In the evening of 16 Oct 2026, Anhui Province published the draft of their new IVD test prices for comment solicitation (link). This is the first province to publicly announce the new test prices following the NHSA's Diagnostics Services Price Items Guidelines in Aug 2026, marking the first step in the regional implementation of China's IVD test price unification. Overall, we think the proposed new test prices are surprisingly favourable to hospitals and IVD companies, based on our analysis of major tests' prices (see Page 2), and our conversations with corporates/ industry experts. Recall that Anhui was the lead province in the provincial-alliance VBPs for CLIA reagent, resulting in at least 20% erosion for the ex-factory price of relevant reagent per our estimates. Given Anhui's significance in China's IVD-related reforms, we believe that its relatively modest test price cut vs. existing prices could offer read-throughs for the broader market. Anhui's comment solicitation ends on 8 Nov 2026 and we await the prices from other provinces in the meantime. A recent media report suggests that Beijing issued its new test prices to hospitals for consultation, with milder-than-feared erosion to current prices.

Largely stable prices vs. status quo for major tests, except infectious diseases

Due to the changes in the services price items, the like-for-like price comparison is only applicable to c50% of the 662 test items, based on our channel check with industry experts and third-party analysis. Elsewhere, c24%/16% tests saw unchanged prices/ price hikes. Only c10% tests witnessed price reduction. By categories, clinical chemistry/ immunoassay/ clinical laboratory (incl. haematology, haemostasis, etc) represent 46%/23%/22% of tests with price cuts and 38%/31%/23% of tests with price hikes, although the test items with notable price changes are mostly those insignificant from test volume perspective, per our expert. Based on our analysis of major tests, there are relatively deep price cuts for infectious diseases immunoassay, with the prices of anti-HBe/ anti-HBc/ HBeAg tests down 40% and anti-HCV test down 30%. However, as the relevant reagents have already seen price reductions under the Anhui-led provincial-alliance VBP (54% average price cut at end-market level for reagent used in the eight-item infectious disease panel test), our expert does not expect meaningful additional erosion to these reagent's prices. Beyond infectious diseases, other common tests from immunoassay, such as tumour biomarkers, hormones and thyroid functions see their prices largely stable. In clinical laboratory, Prothrombin Time (PT) from haemostasis witnessed 8% price cut while 5-Part Differential CBC from haematology recorded 7% price hike. For microbiology, prices for antimicrobial susceptibility test and anaerobic bacterial culture rose 100% and 50% respectively, although the price for routine aerobic bacterial culture dropped 38%.

Surcharges, combined tests discount and reimbursement

On top of the basic test price, multiple items are allowed for surcharges, including but not limited to: 30-50%/ 15-30%/ 50% markups for the adoption of Mass Spectrometry (MS)/ Nucleic Acid MS/ RNA testing in select tests. In addition, Anhui's draft proposed a tiered discount structure for combined tests: 20% discount of the standard price for up to 5 test parameters, 30% for 6-10 parameters, and 40% for more than 10 parameters. That said, most of the mainstream panel tests are not in the scope of "combined tests" per our expert. Lastly, the draft specified the reimbursement coverage for all the tests, with 63% covered by the Basic Medical Insurance (BMI) and 37% self-pay. By categories, microbiology and parasitology tests/ blood group and transfusion tests have the highest coverage ratio, with 95%/ 80% of the test items covered by BMI. On the contrary, molecular diagnostics are mostly out of pocket, with only 24% BMI coverage ratio.

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Figure 1: The proposed new prices vs. current prices for major tests in Anhui

Test category	Panel	Test name (Chinese)	Test name (English)	Abbreviation	Current test price	Proposed new price	Price changes
Immunoassay	Tumour biomarkers	甲胎蛋白	Alpha-Fetoprotein	AFP	32	32	0%
		前列腺特异性抗原	Prostate-Specific Antigen	PSA	50	50	0%
		鳞状细胞癌抗原	Squamous Cell Carcinoma Antigen	SCC / SCCA	50	50	0%
		糖类抗原	Carbohydrate Antigen	CA	50	50	0%
	Infectious diseases	丙型肝炎病毒抗体	Hepatitis C Virus Antibody	Anti-HCV / HCV Ab	90	62	-31%
		梅毒螺旋体抗体	Treponema pallidum Antibody	TP Ab / Anti-TP	20	20	0%
		人类免疫缺陷病毒抗体	Human Immunodeficiency Virus Antibody	HIV Ab / Anti-HIV	46	50	9%
		乙型肝炎病毒抗原（表面抗原）	Hepatitis B Surface Antigen	HBsAg	20	18	-10%
		乙型肝炎病毒抗体（表面抗体）	Hepatitis B Surface Antibody	Anti-HBs / HBsAb	20	18	-10%
		乙型肝炎病毒抗体（e抗体）	Hepatitis B e Antibody	Anti-HBe / HBeAb	20	12	-40%
		乙型肝炎病毒抗体（核心抗体）	Hepatitis B Core Antibody	Anti-HBc / HBcAb	20	12	-40%
		乙型肝炎病毒抗原（e抗原）	Hepatitis B e Antigen	HBeAg	20	12	-40%
	Hormones	雌二醇	Estradiol	E2	37	37	0%
		卵泡刺激素	Follicle-Stimulating Hormone	FSH	37	37	0%
		促黄体生成素	Luteinizing Hormone	LH	37	37	0%
		泌乳素	Prolactin	PRL	37	37	0%
		睾酮	Testosterone	T / TEST	37	37	0%
		孕酮	Progesterone	P / PROG	37	37	0%
	Thyroid functions	甲状腺素	Thyroxine / Total Thyroxine	T4 / TT4	35	35	0%
		三碘甲状原氨酸	Triiodothyronine / Total Triiodothyronine	T3 / TT3	35	35	0%
		游离甲状腺素	Free Thyroxine	FT4	35	35	0%
		促甲状腺激素	Thyroid-Stimulating Hormone	TSH	35	35	0%
Haematology		血常规（全血细胞计数和五分类）	Complete Blood Count with 5-Part Differential	CBC + 5-Diff	15	16	7%
		血常规（全血细胞计数和三分群）	Complete Blood Count with 3-Part Differential	CBC + 3-Diff	12	12	0%
Haemostasis		凝血酶原时间	Prothrombin Time	PT	12	11	-8%
		活化部分凝血活酶时间	Activated Partial Thromboplastin Time	APTT / aPTT	18	18	0%
		纤维蛋白原	Fibrinogen	FIB / Fbg	13	13	0%
		凝血酶时间	Thrombin Time	TT	12	12	0%
		D-二聚体	D-Dimer	D-Dimer	45	45	0%
		纤维蛋白（原）降解产物	Fibrin/Fibrinogen Degradation Products	FDP	30	30	0%
		抗凝血酶	Antithrombin	AT / AT III	30	30	0%
Microbiology		一般需氧菌培养	Aerobic Bacterial Culture	—	33	20	-38%
		厌氧菌培养	Anaerobic Bacterial Culture	—	40	60	50%
		微生物药敏试验	Antimicrobial Susceptibility Testing	AST	5	10	100%

Source: Anhui government website, expert interview, UBS analysis.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We believe the risks facing China's medtech industry include: 1) larger-than-expected price reductions and smaller-than-expected market share gains from medical device VBP programs; 2) weaker-than-expected demand from equipment renewal programs; 3) a greater-than-expected impact from the anti-corruption drive; 4) geopolitical risks affecting the supply chain of medical device products; and 5) slower-than-expected product R&D and technological breakthroughs.

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